the requirements. This was the first and very significant step in the history of Indian missile development, which had so far been restricted to reverse engineering, towards designing our own systems. A long-denied opportunity was at last utilized by missile scientists at DRDL. The message was loud and clear. We could do it!

It did not take long for the message to reach Delhi. Prime Minister Indira Gandhi expressed her desire to personal y apprise herself of the progress of the IGMDP. The entire organization was fil ed with an aura of excitement. On 19 July 1984, Shrimati Gandhi visited DRDL.

Prime Minister Indira Gandhi was a person with a tremendous sense of pride—in herself, in her work and in her country. I deemed it an honour to receive her at DRDL as she had instil ed some of her own pride into my otherwise modest frame of mind. She was immensely conscious that she was the leader of eight hundred mil ion people. Every step, every gesture, every movement of her hands was optimised. The esteem in which she held our work in the field of guided missiles boosted our morale immensely.